NADIA BRENNAN-AZIZ

Cloud Infrastructure / Platform Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cloud infrastructure and platform engineer with 10 years of experience building and operating production infrastructure, including the last 6 years running Kubernetes platforms on AWS. Strong hands-on experience with Terraform, AWS, system reliability, systems architecture and infrastructure design. Leads technical work across platform and product teams. Delivered self-service cloud infrastructure that reduced new-service delivery time from around two weeks to under one day.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud infrastructure and networking: AWS (EKS, EC2, VPC, IAM, RDS, S3, SQS, Route 53, CloudFront), cloud environment design and operation, Kubernetes
Infrastructure as code and delivery: Terraform, Atlantis, Argo CD, Crossplane, Helm, Kustomize, GitHub Actions
Reliability and observability: SLOs and error budgets, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, OpenTelemetry, incident management, k6
Systems and automation: Linux, Go, Python, Bash, Puppet

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer | Tallybrook Ltd (B2B accounting SaaS) *Apr 2022 – Present*
Manchester / remote

- Technical lead for a five-person platform team, operating an AWS EKS platform across 8 clusters and 3 regions, supporting approximately 350 services.
- Designed and built an internal developer platform with Go and Python service templates, Argo CD GitOps, and Crossplane self-service for RDS, SQS and S3. Adopted by all 14 product teams; reduced new-service delivery to production from around two weeks to under one day.
- Led the move from cluster-autoscaler managed node groups to Karpenter, using Spot instances for stateless workloads with interruption handling. Reduced EC2 spend by 38% (approximately £410,000 per year).
- Introduced SLOs, error budgets and burn-rate alerts for the 20 most critical services, agreeing the error-budget policy with product leadership. Reduced on-call pages by approximately 60%.
- Participate in the incident commander rotation and maintain the incident and post-mortem process.
- Mentored three engineers transitioning into SRE from backend engineering.

Site Reliability Engineer | Brightwater Games *Jan 2019 – Mar 2022*
Leeds

- Operated AWS game-backend infrastructure using EC2, ECS and later EKS for titles with up to 1.2 million daily active players.
- Managed AWS infrastructure in Terraform, with approximately 40 modules, and used Atlantis to run plan/apply workflows on pull requests.
- Replaced a noisy Nagios setup with a Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager and Loki observability stack.
- Ran k6 load tests and led launch capacity planning. A test simulating 300,000 concurrent players identified a connection-pool limit that was fixed before launch.

SELECTED PROJECT

Kubernetes cleanup operator | Open source side project *2024*

- Built a small Kubernetes controller in Go using controller-runtime to delete expired preview namespaces; the project has approximately 120 GitHub stars.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science | University of the North Moors | 2016

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | 2021; renewed 2024
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional | 2023

SPEAKING

UK DevOps meetup, 2024 | “SLOs that product managers care about”

LANGUAGES

English (native) | Urdu (conversational)